

D370

IT Leadership Foundations

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

An IT director at a 600-bed hospital leads an electronic health record rollout. She paints a vivid picture of how the system will improve patient care, coaches each engineer on growth goals and challenges the team to rethink old workflows. The project budget is \$4 million and the vendor is based in Wisconsin. Which leadership style is she using?

- A. Transactional
- B. Laissez-faire
- C. Transformational
- D. Autocratic

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A help desk manager sets clear ticket-closure targets, gives bonuses to technicians who hit them and corrects those who miss. Which leadership style is this?

- A. Transactional
- B. Transformational
- C. Laissez-faire
- D. Servant

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A new junior network engineer is excited about the job but has never configured the firm's firewall platform. The team uses Slack, and the office has a standing-desk policy. Under situational leadership, which approach fits best at this stage?

- A. The same style for everyone, always.
- B. Delegating: let the engineer own the task.
- C. Directing: give specific steps and supervise closely.
- D. Supporting: encourage and let the engineer decide.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

During a tense outage review, a systems manager notices her voice rising. She pauses, takes a breath and asks the team to walk through the timeline calmly instead of snapping at them. The outage lasted 3 hours and affected 12,000 users. Pausing and choosing a calm response shows which EI component?

- A. Self-regulation
- B. Empathy
- C. Self-awareness
- D. Social skill, because so many users were affected

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An IT lead senses that a quiet developer is anxious about a reorganization and checks in privately to understand his concerns. Which EI component is this?

- A. Self-awareness
- B. Empathy
- C. Motivation
- D. Self-regulation

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

An IT manager's list includes: (1) a server outage now affecting sales, (2) planning next year's security training, (3) routine status emails a coordinator could send, and (4) browsing vendor newsletters. She drinks a lot of coffee and works from a corner office. Where does task 2 belong in the Eisenhower matrix?

- A. Do it now.
- B. Delegate it.
- C. Eliminate it.
- D. Schedule it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A task is urgent but not important to the manager's goals, such as a routine vendor call a teammate could handle. What does the Eisenhower matrix recommend?

- A.** Do it first.
- B.** Delegate it.
- C.** Eliminate every urgent task.
- D.** Schedule it for later.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A company's VPN drops users every afternoon. For three weeks the support team has restarted the VPN server each day, and users are frustrated. The VPN vendor recently changed its logo. What is the best next step?

- A.** Replace the vendor immediately.
- B.** Tell users VPN drops can never be prevented.
- C.** Keep restarting the server daily.
- D.** Do a root cause analysis, such as 5 Whys and a review of logs around the afternoon pattern.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A software developer at an insurer reports to the head of engineering for her career and performance reviews, but spends most days on a claims-system project where a project manager assigns her work. The company has offices in three states and a casual dress code. Which structure is this?

- A.** Functional
- B.** Matrix
- C.** Flat
- D.** Projectized

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In which structure does the project manager have the most authority, with team members assigned to the project full-time?

- A.** Projectized
- B.** Functional
- C.** Matrix, since matrix always gives PMs full authority
- D.** Weak matrix

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

An infrastructure lead must brief the CFO on why the company needs a \$300,000 storage upgrade. The lead knows RAID levels and IOPS metrics in depth, and the meeting is on a Friday afternoon. What approach is best?

- A.** Walk through RAID levels and IOPS so the CFO sees the rigor.
- B.** Postpone, because Friday meetings never work.
- C.** Lead with business impact, risk and cost in plain language, with technical detail as backup.
- D.** Send a long technical email instead of meeting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A newly formed cloud migration team has started arguing openly about tool choices and who owns which tasks. Two members complained to the manager. The team is split between Dallas and Pune. Which stage is the team in, and what should the leader do?

- A.** Adjourning: disband it, because conflict always means failure.
- B.** Performing: step back and let the team run itself.
- C.** Forming: introduce members and set a friendly tone.
- D.** Storming: clarify roles and decision rules and help resolve the conflict.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

An IT director ~~at a 600-bed hospital~~ leads an electronic health record rollout. She paints a vivid picture of how the system will improve patient care, coaches each engineer on growth goals and challenges the team to rethink old workflows. ~~The project budget is \$4 million and the vendor is based in Wisconsin.~~ Which leadership style is she using?

Target word: leadership style **Decides:** Vision, individual development and intellectual challenge.

A	Confusion set	Focuses on targets, rewards and corrections.
B	Inverted operation	Hands-off, the opposite of active coaching.
C	Correct	Inspiring vision plus developing people.
D	Adjacent category	Decides alone; she invites the team to rethink workflows.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A help desk manager sets clear ticket-closure targets, gives bonuses to technicians who hit them and corrects those who miss. Which leadership style is this?

Target word: style from behavior — reverse **Decides:** Rewards and corrections tied to targets.

A	Correct	Exchange of rewards for performance.
B	Inverted operation	Relies on vision and development, not rewards for targets.
C	Adjacent category	Gives little direction.
D	Confusion set	Puts serving the team's needs first.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A new junior network engineer is excited about the job but has never configured the firm's firewall platform. ~~The team uses Slack, and the office has a standing desk policy.~~ Under situational leadership, which approach fits best at this stage?

Target word: style for this readiness level **Decides:** High commitment, low competence.

A	Absolute language	The model adapts style to each person.
B	Inverted operation	For people with both high skill and commitment.
C	Correct	Eager beginners need clear instruction.
D	Adjacent category	For capable people whose confidence is low.

4. Answer A Concept 3

During a tense outage review, a systems manager notices her voice rising. She pauses, takes a breath and asks the team to walk through the timeline calmly instead of snapping at them. ~~The outage lasted 3 hours and affected 12,000 users.~~ Pausing and choosing a calm response shows which EI component?

Target word: EI component **Decides:** She manages her own emotion.

A	Correct	Controlling an impulse and choosing a response.
B	Adjacent category	Empathy is reading other people's emotions.
C	Confusion set	Noticing the emotion is awareness; managing it is regulation.
D	Camouflage	Outage size does not decide which EI skill she used.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

An IT lead senses that a quiet developer is anxious about a reorganization and checks in privately to understand his concerns. Which EI component is this?

Target word: EI component — others' emotions **Decides:** Reading another person's feelings.

A	Confusion set	About your own emotions.
B	Correct	Understanding others' emotions.
C	Adjacent category	Inner drive toward goals.
D	Inverted operation	About managing your own emotions, not others'.

6. Answer D Concept 4

An IT manager's list includes: (1) a server outage now affecting sales, (2) planning next year's security training, (3) routine status emails a coordinator could send, and (4) browsing vendor newsletters. ~~She drinks a lot of coffee and works from a corner office.~~ Where does task 2 belong in the Eisenhower matrix?

Target word: quadrant for task 2 **Decides:** Important but not urgent.

A	Confusion set	That quadrant is urgent and important, like the outage.
B	Adjacent category	Delegation fits urgent but unimportant tasks.
C	Inverted operation	Elimination is for tasks that are neither.
D	Correct	Important, not urgent work gets planned time.

7. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A task is urgent but not important to the manager's goals, such as a routine vendor call a teammate could handle. What does the Eisenhower matrix recommend?

Target word: action for urgent, not important **Decides:** Urgent, low importance.

A	Confusion set	Reserved for urgent and important.
B	Correct	Someone else can handle it.
C	Absolute language	Urgent and important tasks must be done.
D	Adjacent category	Scheduling is for important, non-urgent work.

8. Answer D Concept 5

A company's VPN drops users every afternoon. For three weeks the support team has restarted the VPN server each day, and users are frustrated. ~~The VPN vendor recently changed its logo.~~ What is the best next step?

Target word: problem-solving step **Decides:** A recurring, patterned failure.

A	Camouflage	Reacts to the vendor detail without a diagnosis.
B	Absolute language	A patterned failure usually has a findable cause.
C	Adjacent category	A workaround that treats the symptom.
D	Correct	Find why it fails at that time.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A software developer at an insurer reports to the head of engineering for her career and performance reviews, but spends most days on a claims-system project where a project manager assigns her work. ~~The company has offices in three states and a casual dress code.~~ Which structure is this?

Target word: structure **Decides:** Two reporting lines: functional and project.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the project manager's line.
B	Correct	A functional manager and a project manager share authority.
C	Confusion set	Describes few layers, not dual reporting.
D	Adjacent category	There she would report fully to the project.

10. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

In which structure does the project manager have the most authority, with team members assigned to the project full-time?

Target word: structure from PM authority **Decides:** Full PM authority.

A	Correct	The project is the main unit.
B	Inverted operation	The PM has the least authority there.
C	Absolute language	Authority is shared in a matrix.
D	Adjacent category	The functional manager still holds more power.

11. Answer C Concept 7

An infrastructure lead must brief the CFO on why the company needs a \$300,000 storage upgrade. ~~The lead knows RAID levels and IOPS metrics in depth, and the meeting is on a Friday afternoon.~~ What approach is best?

Target word: communication approach **Decides:** Audience is a financial executive.

A	Camouflage	Uses the lead's expertise, not the audience's needs.
B	Absolute language	Timing is not the real issue.
C	Correct	Frames the need in the CFO's terms.
D	Adjacent category	Changes the channel but not the message.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A newly formed cloud migration team has started arguing openly about tool choices and who owns which tasks. Two members complained to the manager. ~~The team is split between Dallas and Pune.~~ Which stage is the team in, and what should the leader do?

Target word: stage and action **Decides:** Open conflict over roles in a new team.

A	Absolute language	Storming usually leads to norming.
B	Inverted operation	Too early for hands-off leadership.
C	Confusion set	Forming is polite and tentative, before conflict.
D	Correct	Conflict is normal in storming and needs guidance.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	11	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Transformational vs. transactional leadership	Transformational leaders inspire with vision and develop people; transactional leaders manage through clear targets, rewards and corrections.	Calling any effective leader transformational.	Vision and growth vs. targets and bonuses.
2	Situational leadership	Match the style to follower readiness: directing for eager beginners, then coaching, supporting and finally delegating.	Delegating to someone who lacks the skill.	An enthusiastic person with little experience in the task.
3	Emotional intelligence components	Self-awareness (notice your emotions), self-regulation (manage them), motivation, empathy (read others), social skill (manage relationships).	Mixing up noticing your emotions with controlling them, or your emotions with others'.	Whose emotions, and whether they are noticed or managed.
4	Eisenhower matrix	Urgent and important: do; important not urgent: schedule; urgent not important: delegate; neither: eliminate.	Letting urgent tasks crowd out important planning.	A list of tasks sorted by urgency and importance.
5	Root cause problem solving	Fix recurring problems by finding the root cause (for example, 5 Whys or log analysis), not by repeating a workaround.	Restarting the system every day.	The same failure recurs on a pattern.
6	Functional, matrix and projectized structures	Functional: one functional boss; matrix: a functional manager plus a project manager; projectized: the PM has full authority and staff work on the project full-time.	Ignoring the second reporting line.	Who reviews performance vs. who assigns daily work.
7	Tailoring IT communication	Lead with business impact, risk and cost in plain language for executives; keep technical detail as backup.	Proving rigor with jargon to a non-technical audience.	A technical expert briefing an executive.
8	Tuckman's team stages	Forming, storming, norming, performing (and adjourning); in storming the leader clarifies roles and helps resolve conflict.	Treating conflict as failure, or stepping back too early.	A new team arguing about roles and tools.

Course scope (public description): IT Leadership Foundations is an introductory course that provides students with an overview of organizational structures, communication, and leadership styles specific to information technology in organizations. It also introduces students to some of the power skills that help make successful IT professionals, including time management, problem solving, and emotional intelligence. Students in this course explore their own strengths and passions in relation to the field. There are no prerequisites for this course.